



▲ WEBLEY MODEL 1910

Date 1910

Origin UK

Barrel 5in (12.7cm)

Caliber .38in

Webley of Birmingham, England, produced a range of locked-breech, self-loading pistols from about 1904. They were all designed by J. H. Whiting, who collaborated with Hugh Gabbett-Fairfax on the "Mars" (see p.166), and were adopted by some police forces.

Concealed hammer

Barrel locking lug

Butt houses seven-round removable box magazine

Ejection port



Safety catch

Magazine grip

▲ LUGER P.08
9MM PARABELLUM

Date 1908

Origin Germany

Barrel 4in (10cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

The Luger P.08 is one of the best-known pistols in the world. Luger copied many features of Borchardt's C.93 pistol of 1893 (see p.166), but adopted a leaf recoil spring and moved it into the butt, improving the overall balance considerably. Luger also produced improved ammunition for his pistol, the Parabellum round, which was to become the world standard.

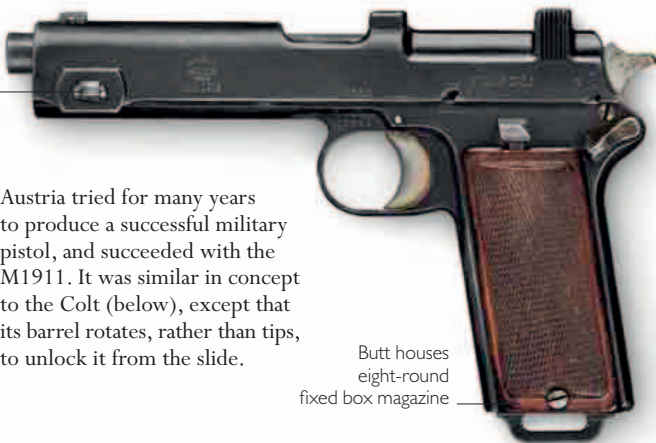
► STEYR-HAHN
MODEL 1911

Date 1911

Origin Austria

Barrel 5in (12.7cm)

Caliber 7.63mm Mannlicher



Butt houses eight-round fixed box magazine

Austria tried for many years to produce a successful military pistol, and succeeded with the M1911. It was similar in concept to the Colt (below), except that its barrel rotates, rather than tips, to unlock it from the slide.



Foresight

Slide

Lever holds slide back for stripping

Recoil spring housing

Patent data

Butt houses seven-round removable box magazine

Toggle doubles up as cocking grip

Ramp breaks toggle joint upward

Safety catch

Magazine catch

Butt houses 10-round removable box magazine

Magazine grip

▲ COLT M1911A1

Date 1924

Origin US

Barrel 5in (12.7cm)

Caliber .45in ACP

Browning designed the Colt M1911 in 1911, following which it was accepted as the US Army's official sidearm. He designed it in response to a demand by US soldiers fighting Moro rebels in the Philippines for a pistol firing a heavy .45in round in place of the less-effective .38in caliber revolvers with which they had been issued. The example shown here is a later M1911A1.